

Business Communication

Course Objectives

- Understanding the importance of realistic business communication process with real life business scenarios
- Adapting writing processes considering different business situations and selecting appropriate words in those scenarios through examples
- Helping the students in learning the differences between formal and informal writing techniques by providing samples of formal and informal emails, letters, memos and reports.
- The course deals with explanation of why communicating clearly across cultures is important to business through case studies
- Helping students constructing their CV and resume through real life samples and preparing them for public speaking

Understanding Workplace Communication

Learning Outcomes

- What is communication?
- Importance of business communication
- Current Challenges
- Categories of business communication
- Communication networks
- The contexts for communication
- The process of communication

What Is Communication?

- The act of exchanging of information by speaking, writing, or using some other medium
- Means of sending or receiving information, such as telephone lines or computers
- Two parties are involved- sender and receiver



Communication Is Important to Business

- Business Needs Good Communication
- Most People DO NOT Communicate Well
- Improved Communication=Better Chances for Success



Why Business Depends upon Communication

- Business must coordinate the activities of groups of people
- Individual business units send and receive information about all aspects of business



Videos on Communication

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YQ3qgIMURgl>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixSUBL1WNxk>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3FfaPhCKZew>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=87HsUukEj4Y&index=4&list=PL058A82A702A180CF>

Group Discussion

- Group Discussion on the importance of communication
- Form small groups and identify at least five advantages of effective communication in the context of a business organization

Current Challenges

- The IMPACTS of Social Media



Current Challenges (Cont.)

- New media are also increasing the needs for employees who have **social intelligence**
- **Social Intelligence** refers to the ability to quickly assess the emotions of those around them and adapt their words, tone, and gestures accordingly
- **Globalization** has given birth to globally integrated organizations and global social networks
- Individuals need to achieve **cross-cultural competency**

Using Social Intelligence on Social Media: Good Example

- Good Example:



michael corrao @michaelcorrao 8 mins

@AmericanExpress terrible service. 24 hr # on the back of my card says they are closed. And if my call is urgent, I am disconnected.

Expand



American Express @AmericanExpress 5 mins

@michaelcorrao Sorry to hear this. Looping in our @AskAmex team as they may be able to help. MB

Hide conversation Reply Retweet Favorite Buffer More

11:04 p.m. - Feb 26, 2013 from Manhattan, NY · Details

Using Social Intelligence on Social Media: Bad Example

- British Airways has been under fire quite a bit for its bad customer service, and social media only promotes its problem
- A customer named Hassan Syed recently paid to promote a Tweet complaining about British Airways' customer service after the company lost his father's suitcase

Here is what Hassan Syed posted on Twitter!



@HVSVN



Don't fly with @British_Airways.
They can't keep track of your
luggage.



Promoted by

What happens next?

- The tweet was seen by 76,000 users
- It negatively impacted on the reputation of the organization
- To make things worse, British Airways failed to respond to the promoted tweet for eight hours

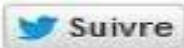
What happens next? (cont.)

- Finally, BA replied to the message!



The screenshot shows a Twitter thread. At the top, a tweet from British Airways (@British_Airways) is displayed. It includes a profile picture of a BA plane and a verified account badge. The tweet text is: "@HVSVN Sorry for the delay in responding, our twitter feed is open 0900-1700 GMT. Please DM your baggage ref and we'll look into this." The date "03 Sept" is shown in the top right. Below this, a reply from @HVSVN is shown. The user's profile picture is a black and white headshot. The reply text is: "@British_Airways how does a billion dollar corp only have 9-5 social media support for a business that operates 24/7? DM me yourselves." The timestamp "10:00 AM - 3 Sept 2013" is below the reply. At the bottom, the engagement stats "47 RETWEETS 31 FAVORIS" are shown on the left, and icons for reply, retweet, and favorite are on the right.

British Airways  @British_Airways 03 Sept
@HVSVN Sorry for the delay in responding, our twitter feed is open 0900-1700 GMT. Please DM your baggage ref and we'll look into this.

 @HVSVN 
@British_Airways how does a billion dollar corp only have 9-5 social media support for a business that operates 24/7? DM me yourselves.
10:00 AM - 3 Sept 2013

47 RETWEETS 31 FAVORIS   

Group Discussion

- Did you ever experience lack of social intelligence while communicating on social media?
- Discuss with your neighbor and share the experience with others

Categories of Business Communication

Main forms of communication in business

**Internal –
Operational
communication**

**External –
Operational
communication**

**Personal
communication**



Three Categories of Business Communication

1. Internal Operational

- Communication Within a Business

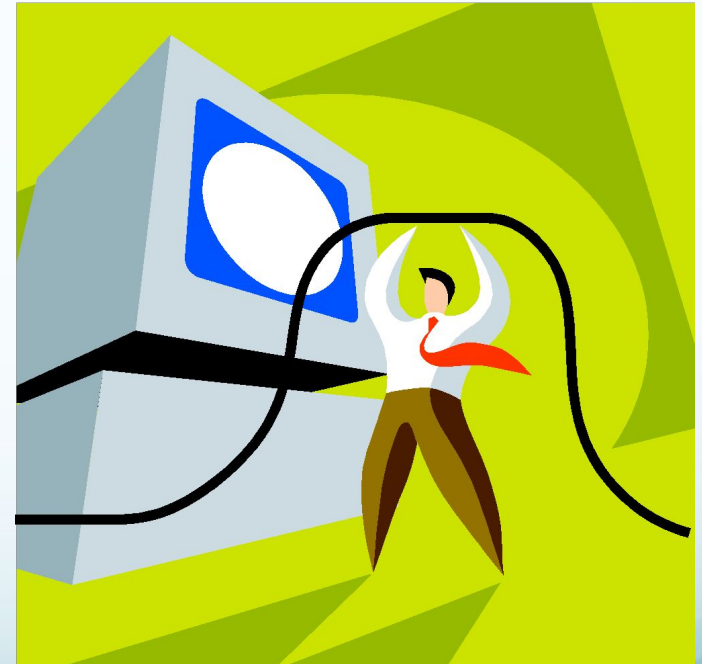
- Giving Orders
- Assembling Reports
- Writing Emails



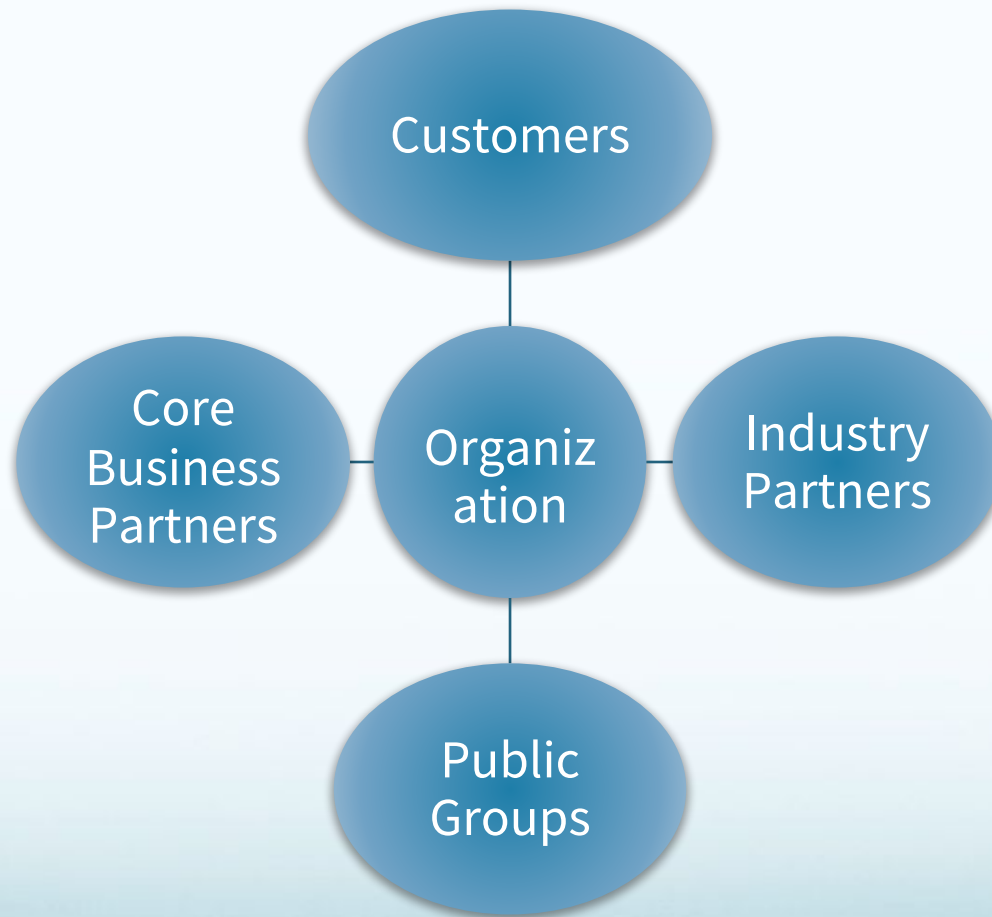
Three Categories of Business Communication

2. External Operational

- Communication Outside Business
 - Personal Selling
 - Telephoning
 - Advertising
 - Writing Messages
 - Displays a Company's Etiquette



External Audiences for Businesses



Three Categories of Business Communication

3. Personal Communication

- Non-Business-Related Information/Feelings
 - Affects Employee Attitude
 - Attitude Affects Employee Performance



Group Discussion

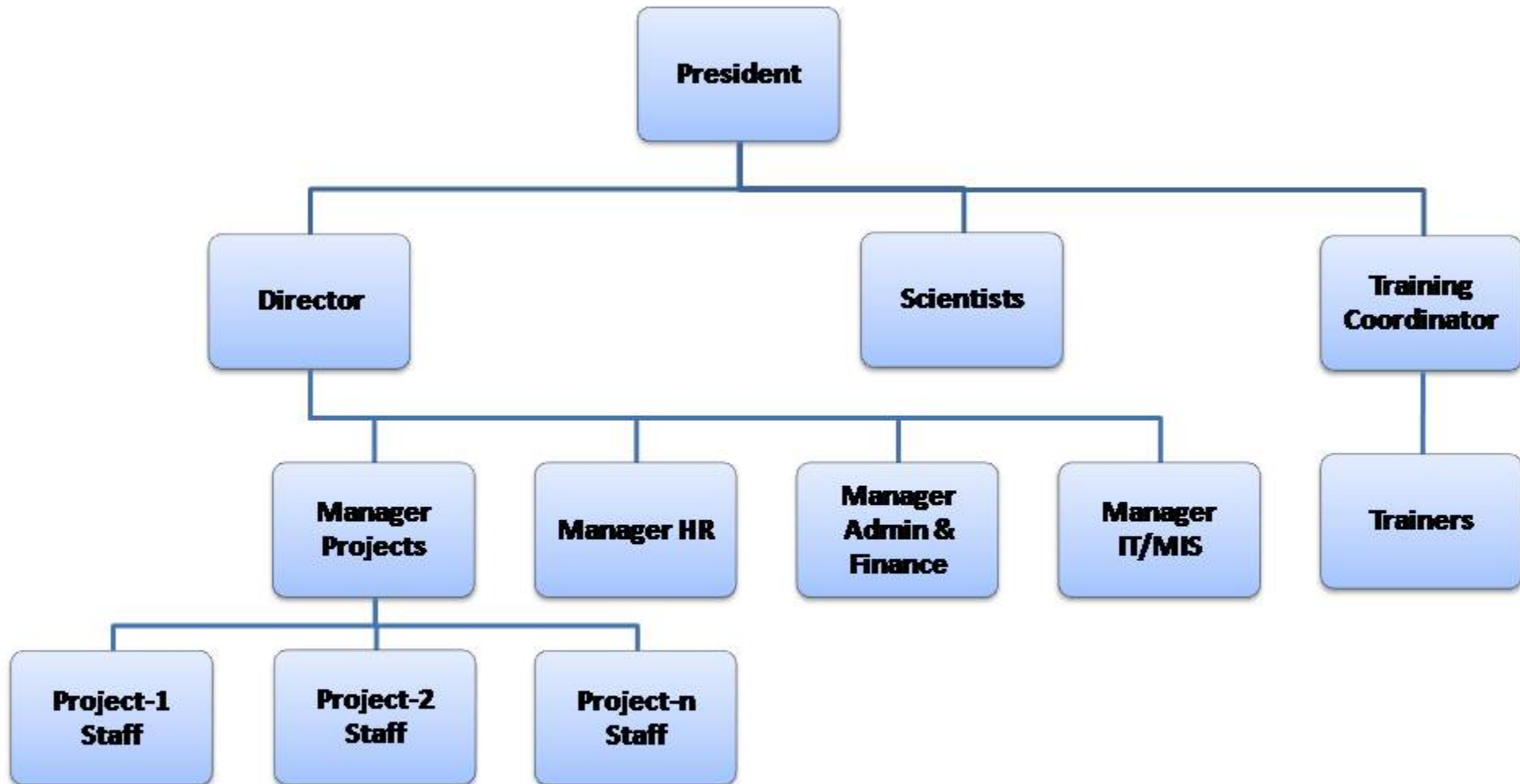
- Group discussion on the types of communication
- What type of communication is most important in the context of a business organization? Give at least 3 reasons to justify your answer.

Communication Networks

Formal Network

- Rules of communication and status hierarchy of the employees
- communication flow through an organogram
- The flow of information includes upward, horizontal and downward movement
- Movement of information by reports, e-mail, records within organization

Organogram



Communication Networks (Cont.)

Informal Network

- Highly Complex & Continually Changing
- Primarily Consists of Personal Communication
- Has No Set Pattern
- Links All members in Organization
-Grapevine communication

Communication Context

- Organizational Context

- Organizational culture
- Your communication is largely shaped by the organization for whom you speak

- Professional Context

- Different people possess different kinds of expertise, speak differently and have different perspectives

- Personal Context

- Depends on the genes you inherited, your family and upbringing, your schooling, your life experiences and culture
- Your current circumstances

The Process of Communication

- Sensing a communication need
 - Why am I communicating ?
- Defining the situation
 - Clear sense of the situation
- Consider possible communication strategies
 - Analyze the contexts and relationship with the audience
- Selecting a course of action
 - Consider the cost and benefit of each option and choose the most optimum one

The Process of Communication (Cont.)

- Composing the message
 - Craft your presentation message or plan your conversation or presentation
- Sending the message
 - It's the time to send your message and you are done!

The Process of Communication (Cont.)

- Receiving the message
 - Your chosen channel has delivered the message to the intended recipient
- Interpreting the message
 - Recipient involves interpreting the message once has received it
- Deciding on a response
 - If the message has been carefully adapted by to the recipients, it has a good chance of achieving the desired goals
- Replying to the message

In class assignment

- Think about a recent transaction you had with a business person or with a staff person at an organization or at DU. Describe the process of your communication.
- if possible, describe the communication context as well
- Form groups and discuss
- Once you have done, send your team representative to present

Summary

- Importance of Communication to You and to Business
- Current Challenges
- Three main Forms of Communication
- Formal and Informal Networks
- Process of Communication